

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

- <think>
- The patient has felt sad for as long as he can remember , which suggests a history of depression .
 - He also reports having worsening suicidal ide ations , which is a common symptom of depression .
 - His difficulty making decisions , hope lessness , and past problems with guilt are additional symptoms of depression .
 - The fact that his symptoms have wors ened over the past 2 weeks may suggest a shift to a more severe form of depression , such as double depression .
 - The patient 's ability to work and get enough sleep suggest that they are not experiencing mania or psychosis , which would disrupt these functions .
 - There 's no specific information given about an hed onia (l ack of pleasure or enjoyment) in the patient .
 - There is no indication of paranoia or other personality disorder traits in the patient 's description .

Given the information provided , the patient 's symptoms align most closely with the description of double depression , which involves the worsening of depressive symptoms over time .

- Option A : The patient is at risk for double depression .
- Option B : The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis (not supported by the information given) .
- Option C : The patient is likely to show an hed onia (not specifically mentioned in the description) .
- Option D : The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder (not supported by the information given) .

The best match for the patient 's condition based on the provided symptoms is double depression .

- </think>
- <answer>A</answer>